

Prompt Library

Every prompt here works in Copilot and in Claude. Adapt the column names to your own data.

CONTEXT

What is it looking at?

Name the sheet. List the columns.
Paste a sample row if the structure is odd.

TASK

What should it produce?

One clear verb: summarise, calculate, rank, flag, draft, rewrite.

FORMAT

How should it come back?

A table, a formula, three bullets, HTML. Say it or you get prose.

The rule that makes all of these work

Never put an AI-generated number in front of a leader without checking it yourself. Filter two or three rows manually against the source. Thirty seconds, every time.

Clinical · Study_Master, Site_Portfolio, Site_Query_Log, Site_Payments

Count sites by status and risk

I have a sheet called Site_Portfolio with columns Site ID, Study ID, Site Status, Risk Level and Open Site Queries. Give me a COUNTIFS formula counting rows where Site Status is Active and Risk Level is High.

Concentration by therapeutic area

Join Site_Portfolio to Study_Master on Study ID. Summarise the count of High risk sites by Therapeutic Area, sorted descending, and also show each area's high-risk sites as a percentage of its own total.

Workload across associates

Count Active sites per Primary TCA in Site_Portfolio. Flag any TCA carrying more than 40 sites and show the total for each.

Closure readiness

For studies where Lifecycle State is Close Out, show how many sites are still Active and how many of those have Open Site Queries greater than zero.

P2P exception breakdown

I have a P2P sheet with columns Invoice_ID, Vendor_ID, Amount, On_Time_Payment, Exception_Type and Cycle_Time_Days. Group by Exception_Type and show count, average Cycle_Time_Days, and the percentage where On_Time_Payment is No. Return as a table sorted by count descending.

Value at risk by exception

From the same P2P sheet, sum Amount by Exception_Type for rows where On_Time_Payment is No, so I can see the value tied up in each failure mode.

O2C ageing exposure

From the O2C sheet with columns Invoice_ID, Customer_ID, Amount, Aging_Bucket, Dispute_Flag and Unapplied_Cash, sum Amount by Aging_Bucket and show what share of each bucket has Dispute_Flag set to Yes.

GA manual entry control risk

From the GA sheet with columns Journal_ID, Account, Amount, Manual_Flag, Posting_Delay_Days and Reconciliation_Status, calculate the percentage of rows where Manual_Flag is Yes and Posting_Delay_Days is greater than 2, broken down by Reconciliation_Status.

Attrition against the company average

From the HR sheet with columns Employee_ID, Function, Region, Tenure_Months, Attrition_Flag and Engagement_Score, show headcount, attrition rate, average tenure and average engagement by Function, sorted by attrition descending. Include the company-wide attrition rate for comparison.

Audit findings by owner

From the Compliance sheet with columns Finding_ID, Owner_Function, Severity, Status, Days_Open and Repeat_Finding, show finding count, percentage Critical, percentage Repeat and average Days_Open by Owner_Function.

Turning numbers into a decision brief

Draft a BLUF from a summary

Here is a summary: [paste your table]. Write a four-layer BLUF for a VP. Layer one is a headline with a number in it. Layer two is why it matters. Layer three is three to five data points. Layer four is a recommendation naming an owner and a deadline.

Rewrite an existing update

Rewrite this update using Bottom Line Up Front. Lead with the conclusion, then context, then evidence, then a bounded action with an owner and a date. Remove any sentence that does not support the headline. [paste text]

Sharpen a weak headline

This headline is a topic label rather than a finding: [paste headline]. Rewrite it so it names a specific number, a place, and a direction, and so a reader knows what decision it supports.

Adapt for a different audience

Here is a brief written for a VP: [paste]. Rewrite it for a global partner team who do not share our local context. Keep the headline identical, expand the evidence to define every term, and change the action to something they can own.

Charts and dashboards

Generate an Artifact dashboard

Here is a table with columns [list them]. Create an interactive HTML dashboard with a sorted bar chart of [metric] by [dimension] and a summary panel. Clean and professional. Add a finding sentence above the chart, not a title.

Refine a dashboard

Revise that dashboard: sort descending, highlight only the top bar in colour and grey out the rest, and replace the chart title with a sentence stating the finding.

Choose the right chart

I want to communicate this one sentence: [your finding]. My data has columns [list them]. Which single chart type proves that sentence most directly, and what should I leave out?

Prompt chaining · four steps from data to decision

One prompt gives you a summary. A sequence gives you an insight. Run these in order, feeding each answer into the next.

Step 1 · Get the shape

Summarise [metric] by [dimension] against the overall average.

Step 2 · Narrow to the finding

Which [dimension] is furthest from the average, and by how much?

Step 3 · Test whether it connects

Does that same [dimension] stand out in [other dataset] on [related metric]? Show both side by side.

Step 4 · Convert to a decision

Draft a two-sentence BLUF recommending where leadership should act first, naming an owner and a deadline.

Where the insight appears

Watch what happens between step two and step three. Step two gives you a fact. Step three tests whether that fact connects to anything else. That transition is where a summary becomes something worth briefing.

When the answer is wrong

What went wrong	What to change in the prompt
The answer is vague or generic	You left out Context. Name the sheet and list the columns explicitly.
It gave prose when you wanted a table	You left out Format. Add "return as a table with columns X, Y, Z".
The formula returns zero	Column letters or exact spelling are probably wrong. Paste one sample row and ask it to check the column references.
It answered a different question	Your Task verb was ambiguous. Replace "help me with" or "look at" with one precise verb.
Numbers do not match your manual check	Ask it to show its working. Usually the grouping or the denominator differs from what you intended.
Quality dropped on a big paste	Too much raw data. Aggregate in Excel first and paste the summary instead.

Copilot or Claude?

- Copilot first. It sits where your data already is, and it is faster for formulas, pivots and short summaries.
- Claude when the task needs reasoning rather than retrieval: long multi-step analysis, Artifact dashboards, rewriting a full narrative for a different audience, or when Copilot has given you a vague answer twice.

AI helps you get there faster. *The judgement about what matters and what to recommend was always yours.*